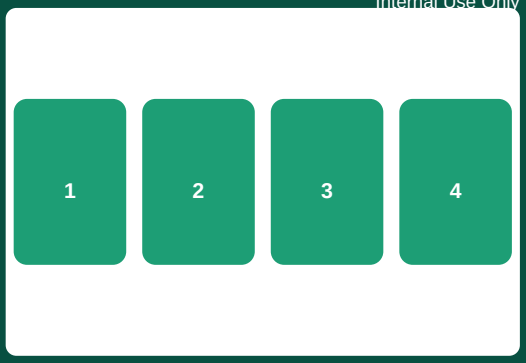
QUALITY & PROCESS

12 Step Kaizen

Run a focused 3–5 day improvement event using a structured 12-step methodology to achieve breakthrough results quickly



WHEN TO USE

When a targeted area needs rapid, measurable improvement with cross-functional team involvement and visible results.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Select theme and set specific targets
2. Form and train the team
3. Observe the current state at gemba
4. Collect and analyse process data
5. Generate improvement ideas as a team
6. Select and plan improvements
7. Implement changes during the event
8. Measure results against targets
9. Standardise the new method
10. Train all affected personnel
11. Report to management and stakeholders
12. Celebrate and plan the next improvement event

PRACTITIONER TIP

Implement on Day 3 — spend Day 4 measuring results. Never leave implementation as a post-event action item.

KEY OUTPUTS

- Kaizen event report with before/after metrics
- Updated work instructions
- 30/60/90-day sustain audit plan

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

% of target achieved during event; improvement sustained at 30-day audit

TOOL CATEGORY

Quality & Process